

Let's Talk About Race in The Anti-Hunger Workplace

A Qualitative Analysis of Organizational Approaches to Addressing Race at Work

By Sofia Charlot, February 2022

Setting The Stage

While conducting this research, the author lived in Baltimore City, Maryland, and learned about the Piscataway people who stewarded this land. She offers an acknowledgment of the colonization of their land by English settlers who then continued to violate established treaties. She acknowledges the continuing efforts of the Piscataway Conoy tribe to work with policymakers to ensure that traditional hunting and fishing rights are recognized and honored—honor and respect for the Piscataway people.

About the Research

This research was a strategic effort to look at the current state, successes, failures, and possible improvements to the movement to end hunger in the United States. Anti-hunger organizations reacted to parallel social justice movements with heightened energy, resources, and attention to the root causes of domestic hunger. Research efforts uncovered whether organizational plans and policies could create transactional or transformational change. This study interrogated the plans, policies, and strategies of organizational approaches to addressing race in the workplace using survey data collection and semi-structured interviews. It also captured how anti-hunger staff and leadership fueled, experienced, and perceived those efforts. Organizations that employed traditional Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) frameworks created surface-level changes that upheld racialized power dynamics in the workplace. Organizational approaches explicitly centered on anti-racism or prioritized naming and addressing racialized power dynamics within their operations—at all levels, with all members, and with the necessary resources—were working towards transformational change. The anti-hunger movement aims to end systemic hunger by addressing its root causes. White supremacy and the racialized power dynamics it creates in domestic food systems sustain widespread hunger and racially disparate outcomes in food security. Anti-hunger organizations must consider how their internal operations either uphold or oppose the racialized power dynamics of white supremacy. They must work towards transforming their institutions into vehicles that push society towards a racially equitable future.

Introduction

On March 8th, 2022, 66 years after the murder of Emmett Till, the United States Senate passed the Emmett Till Antilynching Act in hopes of making lynching a federal hate crime. Emmett Till was a 14-year-old boy visiting relatives near Money, Mississippi, when Roy Brant and J.W. Milam abducted, beat, and murdered him. They accused him, a young black boy, of whistling at a white woman who recently admitted that these claims were false (Pérez-Peña, 2017). The National Association for the Advancement of Colored People (NAACP) classified his murder as a lynching and pursued justice in court. Both men were tried and acquitted by a jury of their peers—white men. They later confessed to murdering Emmett (The Apology, n.d.). Till's mother held an open-casket funeral to show the public murderer his mutilated body. George Floyd cried out for his mother while Derek Chauvin murdered him in broad daylight. His suffering on camera and the video spread like wildfire across the world. Masses of people flooded the streets to protest the latest instance of police brutality. Protesters were met with brutal force as teams of law enforcement suppressed their efforts to organize. While the rest of the United States population sheltered at home during the COVID-19 global pandemic, with their attention trained on the latest symbolic lynching in real-time. The systemic realities of white supremacy were on full display. They had been glaring before; however, this tragedy in this context resonated differently, and understanding why would require a much more robust analysis than the scope of this research plan. Instead, the paper will explore how the ripples from that tragedy impacted the anti-hunger movement.

The events of the summer of 2020 were not the first time anti-hunger organizations considered how their work intersected with issues concerning race. One of the interviewees recounted hosting a session on racial equity and hunger at a national anti-hunger conference in 2017 (personal communication, October 27, 2022). Attendees packed into that session; people stood at the back and outside of the room to listen in. It appears the ongoing issue of police brutality, the racial health disparities underscored by the COVID-19 pandemic, the increased visibility of anti-Asian racial discrimination, the trend of organizations stating their commitments to racial equity, and the increased funding made available to the non-profit sector to bolster emergency response created the perfect storm for racial inequity to take center stage.

This qualitative research analyzes organizational approaches to address race in the anti-hunger workplace. There is literature on racial equity in the anti-hunger space regarding advocacy, research, and direct services. There is also literature on strategic approaches to organizational development. There is no extensive body of knowledge where these topics intersect. Therefore, this project will document existing efforts toward addressing race in the anti-hunger workspace. This study is a strategic effort to look at the current state, successes, failures, and possible improvements to the movement to end hunger in the United States. This analysis includes how anti-hunger staff experience, perceive, and contribute to these workplace efforts. Informants work at local, regional, state, and national anti-hunger institutions. They distribute food, engage in legislative advocacy, offer community outreach, conduct research, give legal services, create coalitions, and more. They either directly align with or contribute to a growing anti-hunger movement.

Research findings will highlight recommendations for how organizations can work towards a racially equitable society with transformation within their internal operations around race. This paper explores the literature to establish definitions and a deeper understanding of organizational development. Next, it details the specifics of the research sample, methodology, data analysis, and findings. Lastly, this paper discusses these themes, contrasts transactional versus transformational change, and wraps up with a conclusion. This research is not exhaustive but sparks an in-depth conversation about how organizations actively create plans to operationalize efforts to address race in food advocacy. It should trigger individuals and organizations to consider the weight of the practices, words, and culture they establish while laying the foundation of this movement.

Literature Review

Conversations with anti-hunger leaders, non-profit staff, and organizational development consultants illuminated topics to uncover via a literature review. They offered resources and served as resources themselves as they contributed to the direction of the research. The first step was setting the foundation for the work by understanding the true definition of terms like racial equity, diversity, equity, inclusion, and anti-racism. In informational interviews and conversations about racial equity within anti-hunger organizations, individuals needed clarification on racial equity, diversity, equity, inclusion, and anti-racism definitions. They often used these terms interchangeably. Baltimore Racial Justice Action's (BRJA) newsletter, entitled Racial Equity Practices, emphasizes the importance of using precise language in the collective fight for racial justice. Specifically, they argue that the appropriation and misapplication of words and phrases like racial equity, diversity, equity, and inclusion causes them to lose value in their capacity to name and call out the issue of racial inequity. This misappropriation keeps oppressive power structures intact as they co-op the language without putting forth any effort or action to embody the definitions behind the words (BRJA, October 2021).

BRJA's 2021 definition of racial equity guides this research: "Racial Equity refers to the time when Black, Native American, and other non-Black communities of color confirm that systemic actions

have repaired societal racialized, generational damages (BRJA)." The definition clarifies that "Racial Equity is a societal debt and obligation; no one institution can practice 'racial equity,' nor can individual institutions offer 'reparations' (BRJA, October 2021)." Institutions and organizations can strive to be racially inclusive by "having in place structures, processes, and policies that remove racialized barriers, resulting in more inclusive participation in institutional and structural power building, sharing, and wielding for traditionally marginalized racial groups (BRJA, October 2021)." This precise language can help food advocacy organizations implement comprehensive goals and internal processes.

Race equity coach Marlysa Gamblin also underscores the importance of using precise language to ensure effective racial equity initiatives. Gamblin argues that diversity means that the demographic makeup of an institution or organization is no longer homogenous. In its simplest form, inclusion means including individuals in processes, programs, and policies. She highlights that neither of these definitions addresses racism (Gamblin, 2021). That "you can have diversity, you can have inclusion, and you can still have racism (Gamblin, 2021)." Racism is a system of oppression that upholds white supremacy and harms other racialized groups according to their proximity to blackness. It is a system of advantage for groups racialized as white and oppression for groups racialized as non-white. That advantage and oppression create disparities in all aspects of our socio-political and economic realities, including social and institutional power, health outcomes, education, professional opportunities, access to food, household wealth, and more. Systems, institutions, and individuals uphold and perpetuate racism in subtle, overt, intentional, and subconscious ways (Gamblin, 2022).

If organizations want to address the ways that institutions and organizations perpetuate the same racialized inequities found in broader society, then diversity and inclusion goals miss the mark. Suppose the societal goal of racial equity is on the agenda for anti-hunger organizations. In that case, they must specifically call out the origins and outcomes of racial inequity instead of its symptoms. When organizations directly name and work against the racialized power dynamics that make their workplaces racially homogenous and exclusionary, the resulting outcomes are workplaces that are racially representative in terms of diversity and inclusive in terms of shared power.

Baltimore Racial Justice Action posits that North American corporate workplace culture created, maintained, and defined the Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) industry. Because of that, the DEI industry took on the same functions and characteristics of these institutions. Ultimately, the intervention they created to rectify workplace institutions still functioned to prioritize the dominant culture, which in this case is white supremacy (BRJA, September 2021). Audre Lorde demonstrates why this industry approach is ineffective when she argues, "The Master's Tools Will Never Dismantle the Master's House." Lorde questions, "What does it mean when the tools of a racist patriarchy are used to examine the fruits of the same patriarchy? It means that only the most narrow parameters of change are possible and allowable. (BRJA, September 2021)" Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion initiatives within the anti-hunger movement only allow narrow parameters of change because the organizations—particularly the leaders and funders—decide the scope and conditions of that change.

Rohini Anand and Mary-Frances Winters detail the history, evolution, nature, and function of Diversity, Equality, and Inclusion (DEI) in "A Retrospective View of Corporate Diversity Training from 1964 to the Present." The authors conceded that the Diversity and Inclusion business lacks the tools to measure changed behavior and work culture. They argue that efforts to promote diversity and inclusion would benefit from a clear definition and understanding of the expected and desired outcomes. For the future of this industry, they recommend organizations fully integrate diversity and inclusion efforts into their everyday business strategies (Anand et al. 2008). Full integration of racial equity or diversity and inclusion practices is a stated goal for many of the organizations in the research sample, yet some Respondents report limited corresponding pushes to operationalize this work into business practice. The

history of corporate diversity trainings detailed in Figure 1 exemplifies how surface level engagement leads to minimal progress (Anand et al. 2008).

Figure 1: A Timeline of Corporate Diversity Training

The Late 1960s - 1970s: <i>Post-Civil Right Act of 1964</i>	The predecessor to diversity training took form, and companies created guidelines for legal and appropriate employee-employer conduct. Training focused on compliance within internal operations and compliance with the law. Early trainings were often short, one-time events with periods of check-ins or refreshers. Employees must confirm receipt of the material and their compliance upon completing this training.
The Early 1980s: An Era of Assimilation	The Civil Rights Act of 1964 increased workplace diversity considerably, but this growth stalled during the Reagan Era. President Reagan favored the deregulation of corporate entities, including matters involving discrimination. In response, companies pulled back from diversity training for compliance.
The late 1980s: The Workforce in the New Millenia	In "Workforce 2000," William B. Johnston posited that the workforce would increase in women and ethnic minorities or non-white racialized groups. These predictions put the concept of workplace diversity on the corporate agenda. They changed the focus of diversity training from compliance to the assimilation of the increasing number of women and non-white racialized groups into racially homogenous workplaces and dominant workplace cultures.
The 1990s: "Managing Diversity"	Roosevelt Thomas argues that "affirmative action is an artificial, transitional intervention intended to give managers a chance to correct an imbalance, an injustice, a mistake. Once the numbers mistake has been corrected, I do not think affirmative action alone can cope with the remaining long-term task of creating a work setting geared to the upward mobility of all kinds of people." The focus shifted from assimilation to fostering sensitivity from the late 1980s to the late 1990s.
	Instead of focusing interventions on women and non-white racialized groups, organizations expended their efforts to include white men in their analysis of diversity with the rationale that everyone benefitted from increased sensitivity to difference. At times, white men became the antagonists of workplace diversity. Staff complained that the broadening scope of diversity efforts no longer prioritized the unique and compounding experience of discrimination for women and groups racialized as non-white in the corporate setting.
	Training included discussions about prominent social experiments, role play, and case studies. They covered topics ranging from cultural awareness, understanding differences, diversity as a good business practice, sensitivity, and compliance. Many large corporations hired third-party consulting; however, with limited budgeted resources, training was short and surface level. Without the time and resources to fully internalize this information, trainees often became confused and frustrated with the process and the idea of diversity altogether.
	During training, women and non-white individuals often felt misunderstood, pressured to represent entire communities of people, and vulnerable to their co-workers' projected or internalized prejudice. Diversity efforts prioritized skills building but did not work to reshape patterns of thinking or create opportunities for transformational change. Popular discourse deemed that the Diversity and Inclusion movement was an overall failure.
The 2000s: "Diversity and inclusion as Good Business Practices"	These lessons informed the next iteration of the Diversity business. Companies prioritized diversity and inclusion for business success and growth. Corporate inclusion initiatives directly responded to increasingly global workplaces, with efforts to make organizations workable for everyone. Both staff and leadership engaged cultural competency as an essential business skill, like leadership or problem-solving.
	Diversity and Inclusion training at the turn of the century positioned difference as something to embrace and use to create better business practices. The work was considered continuous as opposed to the previous one-time training, so the sessions were lengthier and more in-depth. They did not focus on white men or people racialized as non-white; this intervention involved increasing cultural competencies for all individuals.

Nimisha Patel demonstrated the consultation process she employs with the public, education, and human rights organizations. Although this is not a critique of traditional approaches to organizational consultancy, she argues that they are inadequate for addressing institutional racism. When consulting organizations, Patel uses anti-racism as a stance, an approach, and a praxis. It is not in direct opposition to racism or concerned with individual actions or ideologies. As a stance, it pushes up against whiteness and its consequences—racism—with a commitment to create change. As an approach, it centers on the realities of whiteness and the mechanisms that sustain it as a dominant culture. As a praxis, it requires a critical analysis of racialized power dynamics. Precisely, the power whiteness wields to establish normative dominance and how that shows up within organizations (Patel, 2021).

Disrupting whiteness is no small task. It first requires centering whiteness so that it is in full view. In full view, members can interrogate how workplace policies and practices produce, defend, and sustain whiteness. This process utilizes counter-storytelling, direct opposition to whiteness, and acknowledging racism as violating fundamental human rights to position the work. The preliminary consultation is often prompted by moments of crisis when tensions are high, and the need for intervention is urgent. In that initial interaction, Patel prioritizes speaking to staff racialized as non-white at all levels of the organization because they are likely to be hyperaware of the issues and the proposed plan to find a solution. The consultant engages all staff to clarify the nature of the organizational intervention and the reasons behind its need. Early discussions also create a sense of safety and a shared language. It is a collective responsibility to establish the bounds of safety; however, the consultant can facilitate this by acknowledging the discomfort and potential offense that may come up. The goal of shared language is not to dictate right or wrong words or phrases but to create opportunities to understand their meanings and functions more deeply. Next, the consultant explores the internal systems in place and the external social-political context in which the organization operates. This positioning highlights the systems and perspectives that would help situate the process of disrupting whiteness and facilitating an anti-racist praxis. This process requires the consultant to consider their biases and the potential pushback they will receive as they interrogate organizational values and practices (Patel, 2021).

Patel details the 5-stage process she uses to explore whiteness. The process involves answering questions and engaging in grouped or paired discussions. People racialized as non-white can choose to pair up with each other (Patel, 2021).

1. In pairs, staff discuss the following questions: "when did I first become aware of whiteness?" and "How has whiteness been salient in my life, education, and work history?"
2. In small groups, participants talk about their experience talking about whiteness and racism.
3. Teams within the organization discuss the following questions: "What does whiteness look like in our work/team? What does that do, and for whom? How is that responded to in the org? How could/do those responses maintain whiteness and institutionalized racism?" These questions make staff aware of whiteness and the racialization process, make space for counter-storytelling, and make visible how whiteness is defended and upheld.
4. A second round of discussion guided by the same questions in stage 3. This time, with groups comprising a mix of staff from all organizational levels.
5. Discussion can lead to staff creating or participating in racial affinity groups. These groups can initially emphasize and essentialize differences but bringing them back together to continue discussion can deepen understanding of the complexity of whiteness.

After this process, the consultant and the consulted embark on the ongoing process of developing an anti-racism praxis. This process is not limited to a specific timeline and creates purposeful spaces for staff

to continue these discussions. Strict goals and outcomes are not the sole focus of intervention. Whatever progress achieved requires collective responsibility, including senior staff and leadership (Patel, 2021). Patel details how organizational development can disrupt racial power dynamics. By centering whiteness in the anti-hunger movement food advocates can interrogate if their services and internal practices uphold or disrupt systemic hunger.

Makani Themba's "Disrupting the Discourse: Framing at the Intersection of Racism and Opportunity" guided data collection and analysis for this project because this research relies heavily on participants' narratives. These techniques illuminate the racialized power dynamics in their commentary about organizational culture, the anti-hunger movement, and non-profit work. They also center the perspectives of people who experience or acknowledge the worst of racialized power in the anti-hunger workplace, creating opportunities for their words to disrupt those dynamics. Themba advises the following:

- Disrupt dominant frames on race by focusing on why things are the way they are and how they can be different.
- Ask the following questions to develop the social context of the issue: "Who benefits? Who experiences harm? Who has power? Who is left out?"
- Locate unfairness and identify practical solutions.
- Avoid sensationalizing individual stories and experiences over the patterns and structures they indicate.
- Center those most affected instead of becoming preoccupied with convincing and critiquing those with power. Funnel those efforts and resources to build power with those most affected.
- Watch the language used to ensure it aligns with what the people being served want.
- Look for the "hidden transcript," or how people communicate to evade dominant structures. Listen twice as hard to understand the script and catch the double and hidden meanings (Themba, 2005).

Methods

RESEARCH SAMPLE

National & Federal	
Participant 1	does policy development, analysis, and regulations of Federal Nutrition Programs. They describe the work as "meeting the needs of hungry folk" throughout the entire lifespan by interrogating the policies in Federal Nutrition Programs like the Supplementary Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) and the National School Lunch Program (NSLP).
Participant 5	oversees programming and advocacy for a national non-profit network of organizations involved in food advocacy. Their job is to bring together organizations in agreement on advocacy priorities.
State	
Participant 3	is the Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) officer within the outreach department of a state organization. They connect state residents with the Supplementary Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) and the Expanded Food and Nutrition Education Program (EFNEP). As part of the leadership team, Participant 3 ensures that the university meets its civil rights responsibilities and their institutional responsibilities.
Participant 7	focuses on advancing nutritional equity via advocacy and coalition work at a state Health and Welfare organization. They work to improve systems of care and bring equity to the social safety net. They advocate with state agencies and legislature. Their organization provides an umbrella of human services, coordinates a variety of non-profit organizations, and provides direct services to low-income communities in their region.

Participant 10	leads government relations for a network of food banks. They are building their advocacy, public policy, and food distribution capacity beyond providing just emergency food. In this role, they manage community relations with a network of partner food banks, food pantries, and housing shelters.
Participant 12	is a policy analyst for a state law reform institution. The organization focuses on several areas of the law, but Participant 12 concentrates on food security specifically. They identify substantive law, policy, and regulations issues that require systemic advocacy and interact with the Supplementary Nutrition Assistance Program's (SNAP) state agency, the state government and legislature, the media, and federal agencies like the United States Department of Agriculture (USDA).
State & Local	
Participant 9	is the director of a state non-profit anti-hunger and anti-poverty organization. The organization engages in advocacy around legislation, policy, and implementation of policy; specifically concerning a wide range of federal nutrition programs. They provide direct services to state residents through the SNAP outreach. They link, support, and incubate anti-hunger work across the state.
Participant 8	directs projects at a non-profit Public Health institution. The institution brings together cross-sector partnerships to improve public health by creating system and policy change and by incubating model programs. They place community health workers in clinics, community-based organizations, and COVID-19 response.
Participant 11	is the Director of Equity and Inclusion of a food justice organization. Their job is to keep the organization's equity efforts moving and front of mind. They do this by facilitating continuous learning and conversations around the topic and creating and using equity tools. Their organization distributes food to hundreds of food bank partners within the state.
Participant 13	is the CEO of a non-profit anti-hunger organization that engages in direct service and advocacy around access to Federal Nutrition Programs. They build coalitions with local pantries and kitchens, food banks, community organizing groups, poverty groups, unions, housing groups, academic institutions, and other advocacy groups at the state and federal levels.
Regional & Local	
Participant 6	is a part of the executive leadership team of a regional food bank. They lead community outreach involving Supplementary Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) outreach and nutrition education. They also focus on connecting with communities in the region to gauge the impact of services provided.
Participant 2	is a community and partner connector for a regional food bank. They engage in Supplementary Nutrition Assistance Program (SNAP) outreach, community education, relationship building with local organizations, and social and civil services referrals.
Participant 4	works on health equity at a local and regional non-profit think tank. The work is across the health and human services spectrum and involves research at the core. That research informs their advocacy efforts as they testify and lobby at the state legislature.

DATA COLLECTION

Informational Interviews

Data collection started during meetings with anti-hunger organizational leaders, food and racial justice researchers, and organizational development consultants. These conversations detailed the history and dynamics within the anti-hunger space. They also provided insider insight on racial equity in the anti-hunger movement. Conversational partners shared details about their current work description and their career journeys. We talked about what racial equity in the anti-hunger space looked like generally and in their organization. Conversational partners answered questions about their concerns,

compliments, or comments about efforts to address race at work in the anti-hunger space. Informational interviews informed the next step of data collection, the literature review.

Literature Review

The literature review defined racial equity, Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI), and anti-racism and explored how these concepts impacted organizational development and institutional change. An organizational development professional who uses an anti-racism/anti-oppression framework informed this research as a resource on both anti-racism and organizational development.

Race Equity Training

Data collection included participating in anti-racism/anti-oppression organizational development, race equity coaching, and training sessions concerning racial equity or Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI). The principal researcher attended webinars, conversations, workshops, trainings, and informational sessions to observe how anti-hunger organizations addressed race and to scan the resources and information distributed at these gatherings.

Virtual Survey

The informational interviews, literature review, and training informed a survey as the first round of data collection. That first round included questions about the plans, programs, and policies anti-hunger organizations had to address race at work. The survey spotlighted potential conversational partners, collected food advocates' feelings about their organization's policies, and produced a general scan of organizational approaches to race at work. Survey distribution targeted a list of participants who had previously registered for a session on racial equity at a prominent anti-hunger national conference. This sample proved helpful in identifying interviewees willing and able to contribute to a conversation about racial equity in the anti-hunger space (see Appendix 2).

Semi-Structured Responsive Interviews

All the previously mentioned data collection methods informed the interview guides for the semi-structured responsive interviews. Interview questions uncovered organizations' frameworks to address race at work, including the programs, policies, strategic planning, third-party consulting, and training involved. Respondents commented on the impact these efforts had on their organization, what brought about these efforts, and how they experienced or perceived them. Because interviews were semi-structured and responsive, respondents spoke freely, shared stories, provided examples, challenged ideas, and asked questions. There were 13 formal interviews in total. This report excludes any identifiable information out of respect for the candid exchange and precaution for potential repercussions from oppressive power dynamics that seek to silence any challenge to it. See Appendix 3 for the complete interview guide.

DATA ANALYSIS

Informational interviews produced common themes and topics to inform the virtual survey questions. The survey's primary purpose was to pinpoint potential interviewees who were knowledgeable about their organization's policies to address race and were willing to contribute to a conversation about racial equity. The survey included a free response question encouraging individuals to share thoughts, concerns, questions, or hopes about race and racial equity at work. Their responses supplied topics and questions for the formal interviews.

The semi-structured responsive interviews required the bulk of data analysis. An automated transcription service created initial transcript drafts of each formal interview. To ensure accuracy, the principal researcher manually transcribed each interview as well. A first round of inductive coding--using a mixture of in vivo, descriptive, simultaneous, and values coding--produced the following terms and phrases: work description, organizational description, disparities, lived experience, advocacy,

organizational efforts, perceptions of efforts, third-party consulting, strategic planning, training, social context, transformational change, talking about race, paternalism/ white savior complex, representation, leadership/funders, and institutional and systemic power dynamics.

The interview coding guide organized and refined the initial codes into more prominent themes from the data. The themes were The Work, Normalize, Organize, Operationalize, The Experience, and What is at Stake. The next step was a second round of coding. These themes categorized the patterns, commonalities, and inconsistencies within the information provided for each code. They uncovered a narrative about organizational approaches to addressing race at work.

The Government Alliance on Race & Equity's (GARE) Six-part Strategic Approach to Institutional Change provided a framework to analyze the data reported in interviews within the context of institutional change. This report adapted the framework to anti-hunger organizations because it described how they can acknowledge and change internal policies and practices that uphold racial inequity. Additionally, interviews produced vast data describing various activities, programs, and plans. The Strategic Approach helped systemize the efforts by which organizations are trying to institutionalize race at work. GARE's Approach was instrumental when participants could not specifically name their organization's efforts. For example, some referenced their organization's general equity plan even when specifically asked about racial equity. In other instances, participants would use Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI), racial equity, and anti-racism interchangeably, even though they all have distinct definitions and operations. These inconsistencies made it difficult to codify these efforts into discreet groups strictly. The Six-part Strategic Approach to Institutional Change classified these approaches outside the typical naming conventions for racial equity initiatives. See Figures 2, 3, and 4 later in the text for more details about GARE's approach (Nelson, 2015, 10).

Findings

Data analysis uncovered the following codes, themes, and findings.

THE WORK – describes the nature of the work being done and the context in which it is done.

- **Work description** – information detailing the specific job description of the participant interviewed.
- **Organization description** – the organizational context of the work being done including organizational values, priorities, structures, and services provided.
- **Representation** – the demographic make-up of the organizations represented. It involves the feelings, thoughts, and perceived impacts of representation on the work.
- **Lived experience and The personal** – the personal thoughts and experiences expressed by participants as it relates to the anti-hunger work.
- **Social context** – this code captures the socio-political context of the work. Specifically, how social movements inform the work.

NORMALIZE – describes efforts used to normalize these efforts and topics at the workplace.

- **Training** – training topics, formats, and details provided and/or mandated by organizations.
- **Systemic and institutional power dynamics** – efforts to build knowledge around racialized power dynamics in the systems and structures of society. It involves information sharing about racialized historical trauma, root causes of hunger and poverty, and the ways that current policies and practices uphold racialized power dynamics.

ORGANIZE – describes how organizations build capacity to engage in the topic of race at work.

- **Leadership and funders** – were initially about leadership efforts and involvement in addressing race at work. After the first round of coding, I included funders as I realized their role in influencing organizational priorities.

- **Strategic planning** – recent, ongoing, or planned efforts to engage in organizational development via strategic planning including where and how racial equity was or was not included in the plan.
- **Third party consulting** – the nature, scope, and function of the support organizations used in their efforts to normalize efforts and conversations addressing race at work.

OPERATIONALIZE – describes the tools, knowledge, and capacity organizations are building.

- **Advocacy and outreach** – participants locate their advocacy work as the ideal context to operationalize race equity.
- **Racialized disparities** – participants talk about the racialized disparities they witness in hunger and express their commitments or intentions to address the root causes of racialized disparities.

THE EXPERIENCE – describes how individuals experience and internalize these efforts.

- **Perception** – captures how participants perceive efforts to address race at work including the feeling that come up, the impression they have about it, and their overall efficacy.
- **Talking about race at work** – the nature and function of conversations, the topics and feelings that come up during conversations, and the language used in conversations.

WHAT'S AT STAKE – describes what's at stake if race equity work is not operationalized.

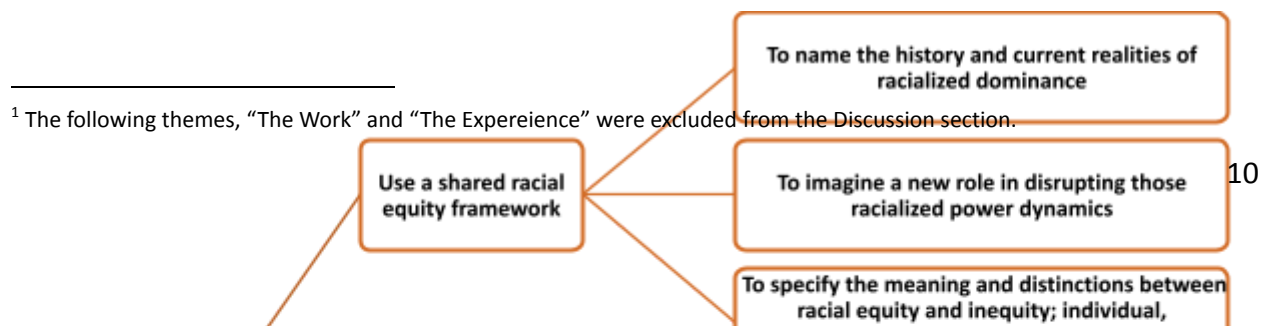
- **Trust and credibility** – participants expressed concern about the trust within their organization and externally within the communities they serve.
- **Paternalism and White saviorism** – the realities of paternalism and white saviorism in anti-hunger work.
- **Transformational change** – the goal of addressing race at work is to create transformational change within the workplace. Participants describe what that change would look like, if they see it happening within their organization, if they see the potential for change, and the possible barriers to change.

Discussion¹

The murder of George Floyd at the hands of Minneapolis police shook the very foundations of society. The events of the summer of 2020 made the racialized power dynamics that uphold and reproduce systemic racism as clear as day for many Americans. Protesters throughout the country took to the streets to demand justice for George and due process for his murderer, police officer Derek Chauvin. Many anti-hunger organizations created statements to communicate their support. They either shifted their stated priorities or doubled down on their current efforts to address racial inequity within their communities. The external social movements and internal pressure from staff required that organizations look at their policies, practices, and priorities to start or recommit to the transformational change process. Some members of these organizations were already talking about race at work; however, these events brought topics of race and racism to the forefront of anti-hunger workplaces in both formal and informal settings.

“There was a turning point because those events were so in your face, and everyone was talking about it. We couldn't do what we usually do, which is ignore stuff (Participant 8, personal communication, January 27, 2022).”

Figure 2: GARE's Six-part Strategic Approach to Institutional Change: Part 1 and 2



NORMALIZE

The Government Alliance on Race and Equity (GARE) advises that organizations use a racial equity framework to name the history of racialized dominance within the broader society and organizations. It also details that they use a racial equity framework to imagine a new role in disrupting racialized power dynamics that uphold whiteness as a norm (Nelson, 2015).

The anti-hunger organizations I connected with primarily engage in activities they hope will normalize race equity work. Some organizations collapsed racial equity within their general equity efforts. Others advertised a general goal of equity but led with race to set the parameters of change for issues concerning gender, age, or ability. Their strategy is as follows: "We are explicit about leading with race because we believe that having deep conversations around race allows us to have more impactful and fuller conversations around all other types of oppression (Participant 11, personal communication, January 31, 2022)." Some organizations have yet to locate a specific approach or framework and instead communicate an intention or commitment to racial equity. Intentionality and commitment are necessary, but so is specificity.

Some organizations are specifically normalizing racial equity. That normalization process is necessary, as one participant expressed that after working in the non-profit sector for over ten years, they noticed that "there was this euphemism when talking about any social issues. Nobody would ever say anything about race. They would talk about poverty, classism, or economic inequality. (Participant 7, personal communication, January 27, 2022)." Another participant said that at this part of their organization's journey, "conversations around institutional racism is part of the language discussion so that people get comfortable understanding that there are systemic issues that we need to talk about (Participant 10, personal communication, January 28, 2022)." Participant 11 described how they facilitated the normalize process within their organization; "a big focus of my work for a couple of years in socializing, naming personal, cultural, institutional levels of racism, and just getting us in that headspace as an organization (personal communication, January 31, 2022)."

Almost all the organizations in the sample use training in the normalization process. A couple of participants report no ongoing sessions, but they see the need for it within their organizations. For those

that do, training started as a direct response to staff requests for tools and resources to assist their personal and professional interactions with race and racism. Some organizations sought training in reaction to racially charged incidents or conflicts amongst staff, leadership, and the communities they serve. Organizations predominantly named the parallel social movements as the drivers of their training efforts. The social unrest that erupted after the murder of George Floyd pushed many anti-hunger organizations to question what their first steps in should be addressing race at work. Their initial response was training to build shared knowledge around racial equity, anti-racism, or Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI). Some trainings focused on individual experiences and interpersonal interactions with topics like unconscious bias, racial and cultural awareness, stereotyping, and civil rights compliance. Others highlighted the historic and ongoing systemic and institutional realities of racism, power, and privilege. Those training sessions covered topics like reframing racism, racial equity in anti-hunger work, racialized disparities, whiteness, and white supremacy.

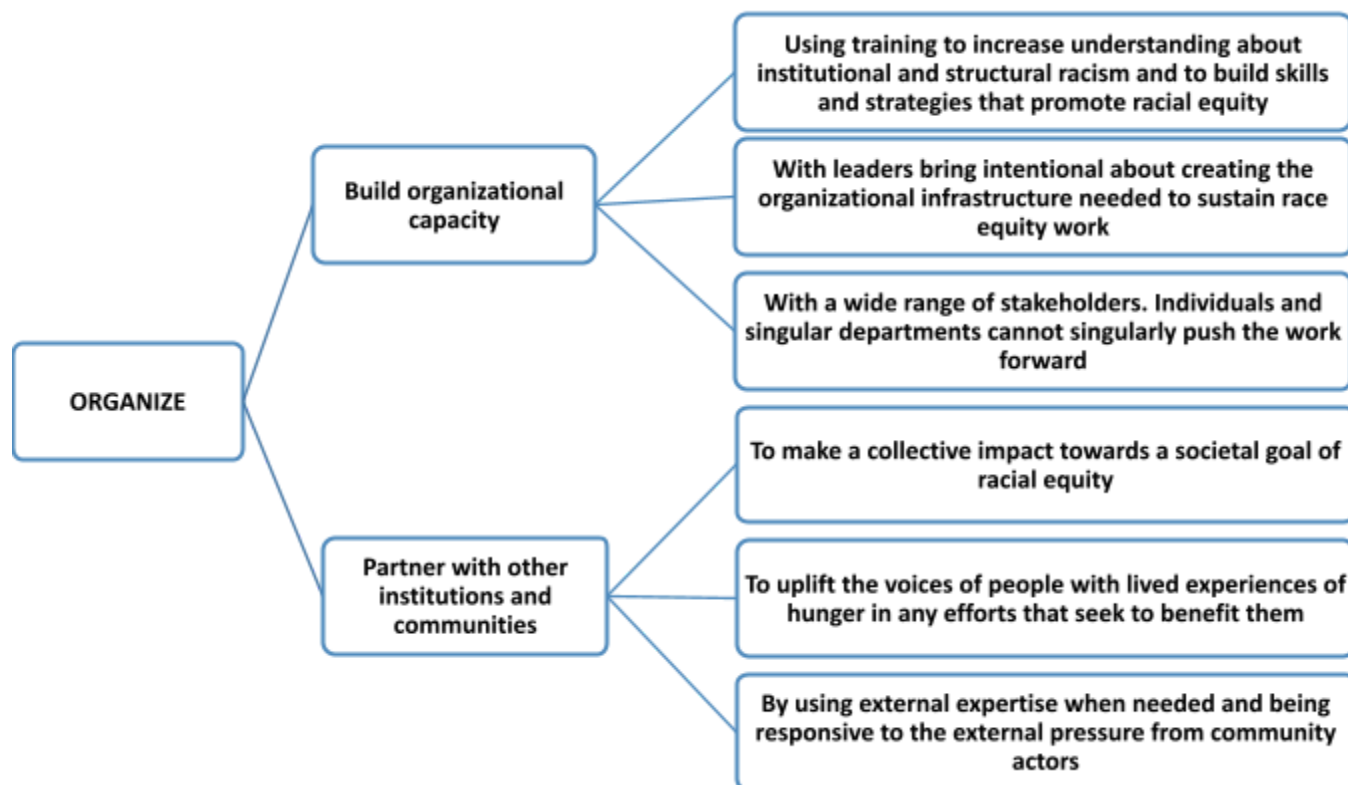
There must be knowledge-building and normalization around the systems and structures that uphold racism. Individual and interpersonal interventions have their place; however, any intervention that fails to address the racialized power dynamics in systems, structures, and legacies is incomplete at best and in direct opposition to progress at worst. Training that prioritizes individualist interventions flattens and misrepresents the dynamic reality of systemic and institutional racism. It perpetuates a false sense of progress as individuals work on internalized and interpersonal issues and leave the structures, policies, and practices that perpetuate racialized power dynamics untouched (Anonymous informant, personal communications, January 11, 2022).

The normalization process requires that organizations communicate with urgency and accountability regarding racial equity. That looks like conceiving formalized measures to keep organizations accountable and building the public will to collectively work towards racial equity urgently (Nelson, 2015). In response to the general urgency around diversifying staff in hopes of practicing race equity work, participant 5 advised organizations with predominantly white staff and leadership to "start doing racial equity work. That is probably the quickest thing to diversify those groups. Once you start doing that racial equity work, the community will force you to confront yourself (personal communication, January 26, 2022)." This advice focuses on the societal goal of racial equity rather than the transactional goal of increasing the number of staff racialized as non-white. One anti-hunger organization's equity department is responsible for keeping the organization as a whole and internal departments accountable to their company's equity commitments. Although not officially codified in their process, this organization leads with race first because "that is the one we will quickly push off to the side (Participant 11, personal communication, January 31, 2022)." Because they witnessed their efforts undermined by the organization's inconsistency, Participant 11 recognized the need for urgency concerning race at work. Accountability is critical in organizations with individuals resistant to change. One participant described how adopting policies prioritizing racial equity created accountability for those who had not bought into the work. They continued, "At that point, it is a part of their jobs (Participant 5, personal communication, January 26, 2022).

The challenges one participant faced demonstrated that no accountability stifled urgent movement. They reported that most of the people in their organization were committed to anti-racism as a stance and approach to their everyday work. They faced direct opposition from one individual who held a disproportionate amount of power. That same person's influence restricted official lines of communication around racial equity at work (Participant 7, personal communication, January 27, 2022). Additionally, Participant 7 described the area they live and work in as incredibly racist, white supremacist, and regressive. They, along with their coworkers, saw glaring systemic issues and the need to address them directly with advocacy work; however, that one person blocking change was not held

accountable to the priorities of the rest of the staff (personal communication, January 27, 2022). Another interviewee shared that with efforts to address race at work, "you have to have the board and senior leadership moving that forward because staff can come to you and have great ideas, but if they do not feel empowered to push it forward, it does not go anywhere (Participant 10, personal communication, January 28, 2022)." Leadership plays a prominent role in setting the tone of urgency. Their influence either advances or inhibits the normalization process in the anti-hunger movement.

Figure 3: GARE's Six-part Strategic Approach to Institutional Change: Part 3 and 4



ORGANIZE

Institutionalizing race equity work in the anti-hunger movement requires organization. That organization process creates the infrastructure necessary to sustain the work. That scaffolding is critical because participants express frustration that efforts to address race at work are unsustainable. They see their organization's immediate and reactionary response to external cues around social justice as performative without accompanying structural or cultural change. Building organizational capacity entails an organization-wide commitment to the full scope of transformational change and formalized structures and processes that sustain that change. The individuals I connected with describe myriad ways their workplaces organize structures that can withstand the push and pull of social currents. Leaders and funders are responsible for securing adequate resources and personnel to maintain that organizational capacity.

Anti-hunger groups are using strategic planning to organize. Their planning efforts build organizational capacity by creating permanent positions and departments to advance their efforts. One participant delineated the creation and growth of the equity department in their organization. As the department grew, the organization's race-first focus expanded to consider the root causes of racialized

disparities in hunger (Participant 11, personal communication, January 31, 2022). Several participants noted that strategic planning led to the creation of staff committees, staff and board committees, staff working groups, and special committees for the members of the communities they serve. Some planning efforts explicitly name racial equity as a priority, but most use the language of Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI). A few are intentionally undergoing strategic planning using a race equity lens. One participant decided to engage in strategic planning using an anti-racism/anti-oppression framework "not because racial equity is more important than strategic planning or that strategic planning is more important than racial equity. We cannot do strategic planning without understanding how race plays a role in the work and has historically played a role in the work (Participant 9, personal communication, January 28, 2022)." Several of the organizations in the sample have racial equity, equity, or Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) as a pillar within their general plans for organizational development. As they detailed that dynamic, they almost always conceded that their efforts could not happen in a silo. The values, plans, and goals for their specific approaches to addressing race at work should extend throughout the plan.

"We are building our next 3-5 year strategies... and weaving our equity commitments to our social commitments and thinking about justice and liberation and not just charity (Participant 11, personal communication, January 31, 2022)."

Some participants took on anti-racism work in addition to their specific roles even when their organizations did not have codified plans or policies to formalize it. Others knew they wanted to engage their anti-hunger efforts with anti-racism but had yet to define how to do that within their organizations. The leader of an anti-hunger organization described their excitement for the recruitment process of a new internal position. Their specific role will be building the organization's infrastructure to address race at work as part of strategic planning efforts (Participant 13, personal communication, January 28, 2022). Some organizations strategized transactional change in hopes that it would translate to transformational change. They reported plans to change their hiring practices to increase the number of people racialized as non-white. Creating workplaces that are no longer homogenous is a respectable goal; however, efforts to do so will be transactional unless organizations address the racialized power dynamics that created the representation issue in the first place. Overall, organizations are at a variety of stages of strategic planning. Some are in the data collection and analysis phase using the information gathered from staff surveys. They hope to use this information to inform an action plan moving forward. Others were on the second or third iteration of strategic planning; COVID-19 required some redirecting attention and resources to emergency food response.

To build capacity, organizations cannot rely solely on voluntary efforts to address race that staff create and lead. These efforts are often outside of their job descriptions and involve unpaid labor. The burden of this work falls disproportionality on Black staff and other individuals racialized as non-white. They often volunteer to lead the work because it resonates with their experiences and passions. Passion and urgency should not be the only driving forces of approaches to address race within anti-hunger organizations. Infrastructure in the form of paid professionals, formalized lines of feedback, resources, and budgets should accompany staff initiatives that have upheld efforts thus far. One participant led a monthly virtual meetup where staff discussed books, media, and other content about race, identity, and society. Their executive director supported this effort by allowing staff to consume the content during their workday and reimbursing them for the materials needed to participate (Participant 4, personal communication, January 25, 2022).

Regarding their organization's Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) committee, Participant 4 shares, "I thought that as a co-chair, I could take some ownership, [but] it seems that it is still in the hands of my executive director. When things get busy, optional things that do not help the

organization run or raise money [are] one of the first things to go by the wayside (personal communication, January 25, 2022)." Leadership can use staff efforts to inspire the creation of internal mechanisms that bring about transformational change. Their support, or lack thereof, demonstrates their commitment to building organizational capacity to address race at work.

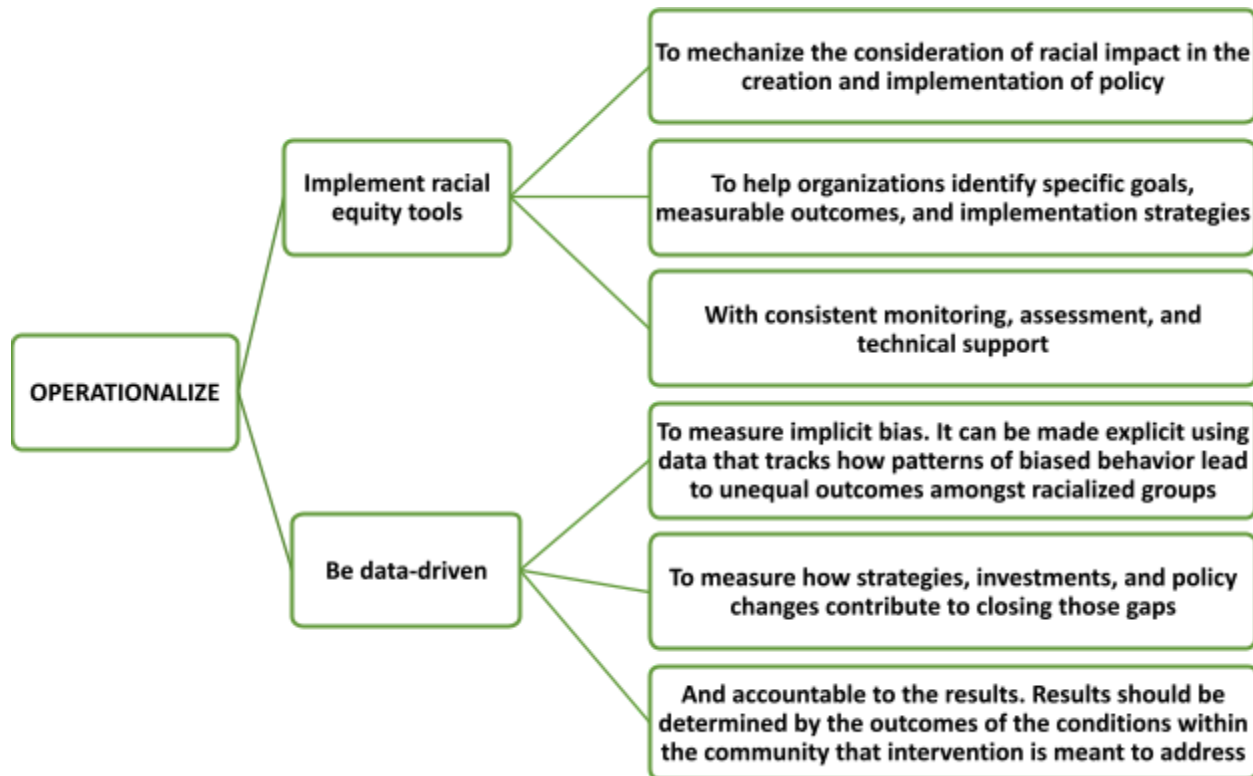
"I think the hardest part for me is overseeing all the priorities that we are building... I make sure they have all the tools they need, but I'm one person. So as an organization, I think that is something that we all need to look at (Participant 6, personal communication, January 26, 2022)."

Organizational leaders and funders are instrumental in building organizational capacity to address race at work. Some leaders facilitate the work themselves, while others are convinced to buy in via their staff efforts. Some staff even face direct opposition from leadership who use the lack of funding and relevance to justify inaction. Generally, participants report that their leadership teams were open to the staff's concerns and questions. Leadership was at least willing to engage with the most immediate issues or seek external expertise to pinpoint growth opportunities. Participant 11 attributed the transformation within their leadership team and board to years of internal equity work that leads with race. Their CEO was committed to addressing the root causes of hunger and believed that the best people to lead that work were those with lived experience of hunger, poverty, and racialized oppression (personal communication, January 31, 2022). Even so, organizational leaders have to answer to funders. Several participants are leaders themselves, and they described the tension between wanting to build organizational capacity, meeting requirements to maintain current funding, and getting 22 funders to prioritize their internal approaches to address race. Participant 12 shared that "because of external funding in our work, there is never an acknowledgment of the importance of doing Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) related internal work. So, it is an add-on. That is probably one of the biggest flaws I see (Participant 12, personal communication, January 31, 2022)."

Third-party consulting is another tool anti-hunger organizations use to build their capacity to address race at work. The consultant's reach varied throughout the sample of organizations. Most of them had consultants interact with just the leadership team or with the leadership team first. At a few organizations, the consultant worked with all levels of staff. The goals, formats, and topics covered by the consultant differed according to each organization. Participant 1 reported that their organization's goals for third-party intervention were to create a more respectful workplace, provide a safe space for discussions on racial bias, and help staff gain skills in incorporating Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) into their personal and professional lives (personal communication, January 13, 2022). One organization underwent strategic planning and development using an anti-racism/anti-oppression framework (Participant 9, personal communication, January 28, 2022). Participant 11 detailed how a consulting firm helped build their organization's capacity and knowledge by working with their internal equity team. In tandem, they created structures to sustain the work after consultation and developed tools that helped them see the racial impact of their work (personal communication, January 31, 2022).

As third-party consultation demonstrates, cooperative partnerships with communities and institutions can be a fruitful organizing strategy. Participant 2 stated that their organization intentionally highlighted and shared resources with communities of color and businesses owned by people of color (personal communication, January 20, 2022). Another participant described working groups of anti-hunger professionals from different organizations, all seeking and imagining ways to operationalize race equity in their anti-hunger work. Diverse coalitions of anti-hunger organizations present an excellent opportunity to organize approaches to address race at work. One collaborative effort made tools, training, technical assistance, and consultation available to their members to support their racial equity commitments (Participant 5, personal communication, January 26, 2022).

Figure 4: GARE's Six-part Strategic Approach to Institutional Change: Part 5 and 6



OPERATIONALIZE

Most of the sample does food advocacy work and has considered how to prioritize racial equity within that context. Some interviewees specifically concentrated on racial disparities in hunger and poverty. They saw their efforts to address race at work as a launching point to address the dynamics of racialized identities and hunger. The Government Alliance on Race and Equity (GARE) describes how organizations can operationalize race equity using tools, data, and metrics. Racial equity tools create formalized ways to consider the racial impact of plans, policies, and practices. Their consistent use can push organizations towards incremental change that can add to large-scale changes (Nelson, 2015). Anti-hunger organizations can use racial equity tools to create new policies and reconstruct old ones that perpetuate systemic racism. "Once we started doing this training, people were like, 'Okay, so now what? We can understand this intellectually, but what does this mean for us as anti-hunger organizations (Participant 5, personal communication, January 26, 2022)?"

A few participants are using racial equity tools in their anti-hunger work. One described a tool that helped individuals doing anti-hunger work get a deeper understanding of the role that policy plays in creating and maintaining racialized disparities. They created and distributed another tool that allowed organizations to assess the racial impact in their work. Since the assessment is self-guided, this tool can benefit anti-hunger organizations that do not have budgets for third-party consultation (Participant 5, personal communication, January 26, 2022). Another tool enlisted in advancing race equity work had a simple design but made a complex impact. It was a series of questions they considered before any significant decision. Anyone in the organization could use the tool at any point in a program, plan, or decision, allowing communication and accountability "across power differentials (Participant 11, personal communication, January 31, 2022)." The questions brought the following considerations to the forefront of any process: what equitable outcomes did this achieve, are stakeholders intentionally and

meaningfully included in the process, did it have the potential to harm people with lived experience of oppression generally, and hunger specifically, would it advantage people or groups that traditionally benefit from privilege and risk upholding whiteness as dominant culture (Participant 11, personal communication, January 31, 2022)? Tools are necessary; however, transformational change is unique to each organization's culture, and a tool is not a blanket solution. In general, organizations should use tools to standardize their analysis of racial impact without using them as cut-and-paste formulas for change.

All participants at least alluded to the existence and relevancy of racial disparities when talking about their anti-hunger work, especially in advocacy. Data that locates a problem is imperative to its solution; however, racial equity is not solely about locating disparities. Racial equity is the goal of efforts to address and rectify racial inequities (Gamblin, 2022). It is action-oriented and accountable to observable changes in racially disparate outcomes. In organizational development, participants located racial disparities in their workplaces, the anti-hunger movement, and the non-profit sector. To them, the most glaring issue is the racial leadership gap. Black, Indigenous, Latinx, and other communities of color have disproportionately high rates of food insecurity, yet anti-hunger leadership is disproportionately white. Their observations indicate that anti-hunger advocates are aware of this problematic dynamic. What remains generally, granted not entirely, unsaid are the actions that can rectify this misappropriation of power. Where is the data related to the outcome that anti-hunger advocates want to see? That outcome is leadership that is racially representative of the communities they serve. Leadership, funders, staff, and other stakeholders should hold themselves and each other accountable for the timely, appropriate, and productive use of tools and data within their approaches to address race at work if they hope to operationalize it in the fight to end hunger.

WHAT'S AT STAKE

The interview questioned what is at stake if anti-hunger organizations do not prioritize racial equity at work. Most respondents cited distrust from the communities they aim to serve and their organization's credibility. Both concerns deal with their organization's ability to continue doing anti-hunger work. If the communities anti-hunger organizations serve do not trust them enough to use their services, then that essentially renders them useless. Additionally, if anti-hunger organizations lose their credibility, their funding, partnerships, and public support might soon follow. Internally, organizations risk staff turnover if they do not create the infrastructure to operationalize race equity work.

"There is absolutely no reason for trust amongst any of those 'non-traditional groups' because at best we've ignored them, and at worst we have actively harmed them. So the onus is on us to put ourselves in a complete and total position of service (Participant 3, personal communication, January 24, 2022)."

Also at stake is the maintenance of oppressive norms in the anti-hunger space, specifically white saviorism and paternalism. Participant 1 observed, "Paternalism is ingrained in the fact that we are telling people 'When feeding children, this is what you need to do' (personal communication, January 13, 2022)." They described how federal anti-hunger senior leadership and their immediate ranks have been male. At the same time, the participants of the services they influence are predominantly female (personal communication, January 13, 2022)." Concerning paternalism, another participant asserted that "many things in public health are just fact. They do not change with time (Participant 4, personal communication, January 25, 2022)." Participant 6 observed that people working in food banks and distribution sites often make assumptions that they know what foods are the best for others or that they are serving everyone in a community. They note that "we are quick to pat ourselves on the back because we served 20 million meals, but who cares? We will continue serving 20 million meals (personal communication, January 26, 2022)." They questioned how to address hunger's root causes and systemic

realities so that people are not beholden to food banks, non-profits, and charities. Participant 2 echoed those sentiments because, to them, "the idea is to work themselves out of a job (personal communication, January 20, 2022)." Work that prioritizes racial equity pushes up against white saviors and paternalism. Participant 5 used racial equity technical assistance to help organizations uproot white saviorism practices in their anti-hunger work. They challenged organizations to consider, "Did you come out of nowhere saying 'we know what is right for you,' or are you working with communities to co-create solutions and to empower community members to be part of that solution? (personal communication, January 26, 2022)" Participant 13 contributed, "Having people utilize their voice is very different than being their voice. We do not need to put a face on hunger. They already have faces (personal communication, January 28, 2022)."

What is mostly at stake is the possibility of transformational change. A few participants felt their organization's efforts would not lead to transformational change. Participant 1 appreciated their organization's Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) efforts because of the resources, information, and skills they gained; however, they did not see these efforts transforming their organization (personal communication, January 13, 2022). Another conceded that "at this point, what we are doing is probably as good as we are going to get because it is not on anyone's radar to do the real work (Participant 2, personal communication, January 20, 2022)" in regards to their organization's Diversity, Equity, Inclusion, and Access efforts. Although they noted that the transformational change process is ongoing, some participants were enthusiastic about the changes they had already seen. Participant 5 reported, "Our mission was to make [racial equity] a mainstream conversation in the sector. It is now a mainstream conversation. The question then is, what are groups doing about it? There is much talk. There are lots of new money around it. I think there are a lot of new initiatives, but the work itself is very recent (personal communication, January 26, 2022)."

Several responses were somewhere in between. "I do see that it can happen. I think the material piece is where we are having difficulties. Everybody is struggling with their finances," commented Participant 3. With the appropriate resources, they hoped to "initiate a full culture shift (Participant 3, personal communication, January 24, 2022)." Another participant was excited to see their organization seizing the opportunity to operationalize anti-racism within their work. They shared, "I hope we can keep that momentum because this is long-term work, and I think we have seen the pushbacks and the blowbacks already (Participant 8, personal communication, January 27, 2022)." Participant 9 thought there was potential for transformational change with their organization's efforts but had reservations because "transformational change is hard and rarely happens (personal communication, January 28, 2022)." Participant 11 already saw evidence of transformation within their organization but understood that process to be ongoing (personal communication, January 31, 2022).

Participant 12 made an important point about the conditions needed for transformational change, "I do not think there are many resources or that we necessarily have enough at all. Another factor is the time that staff has to be able to participate and reflect while juggling the demands of their work and their funders. So one question is whether or not we can transform some of the expectations of the organizations that fund us (personal communication, January 31, 2022)." Participant 13 echoed a similar concern. Transformational change is possible "if we get the resources to build a national movement. To be truly transformational, you need a social movement that will force it to happen because it will not happen on its own (personal communication, January 28, 2022). Participant 9 considered all aspects involved in creating transformation when they stated, "It happens because of sustained leadership engagement and involvement, with multi-level efforts; whether its legislative, political, communities, communication, all of those things (personal communication, January 28, 2022)."

"We'll just keep with the same status quo. We will keep working at the surface level, but we won't do anything to make sure that systemic changes are made," notes (Participant 8, personal communication, January 27, 2022)."

Most participants expressed concern about the barriers to transformational change and considered what is at stake if anti-hunger organizations do not prioritize transformation. Participant 3 is a diversity professional working in a state that prohibits any mandated Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI) efforts. They are a team of one, yet they are still determined to transform the culture around diversity and inclusion in their organization (personal communication, January 24, 2022). Another participant lives in a state where "every time there is progress on a broader scale, [the state] pushes against it (Participant 7, personal communication, January 27, 2022)." Those dynamics affected how the organizations formally considered racial equity in their anti-hunger work. Organizational capacity was an issue for Participant 13, who stated, "We had no one whose job it was to do this stuff, so we have added it on to other things, but it is tough when we are struggling to make rent every year (personal communication, January 28, 2022)." Another hoped that transformational change could push back against the U.S. "history of going forward and then backward, of making progress and then having a reaction (Participant 9, personal communication, January 28, 2022). Anti-hunger organizations cannot transform society themselves; however, they can transform their operations to contribute to the societal goal of racial equity.

Conclusion

Research participants underscore the need for transformational change in the Anti-hunger movement. To model what that looks like, this report adapts GARE's criteria for change and uses interview findings to make precise comparisons between transformational and transactional change (Nelson, 2015, 51). See Tables 3 and 4.

Table 3: Transactional Change Transaction in Anti-hunger Organizations

Solves technical problems	A few participants describe their organizations' efforts to diversify the racial demographic by hiring more non-white staff. This solves the numbers problem but does not guarantee that the diversity will represent the communities they work within and the people they serve. New hires and existing staff may feel these efforts tokenized people racialized as non-white.
Problem is easy to identify	Participant 11's CEO made concerted efforts over several years to change their board and leadership team from majority white and male to majority Black, Indigenous, and other women of color. These efforts were not easy, but the problem of a homogenous leadership team was easy to identify.
Routine solution using skills and experience readily available	A few organizations undergo routine strategic planning protocols with specific timelines and deliverables. The parameters of change are already established before the process. Racial equity or Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion may or may not be a discreet part of the plan.
Often solved by an authority or expert	A few organizations hired organizational development professionals to locate problems and solutions or facilitate general strategic planning. The consultant leads the race equity initiatives, and the end of their contractual agreement signals the end of those efforts. Ultimately, the consultation process does not create internal structures to sustain the work.

Requires change in just one or a few places, contained within organizational boundaries	One organization concentrates its Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion work within its outreach department to interact with community members, external stakeholders, and potential non-white staff recruits. This institution must consider how the entire organization could benefit from confronting why and how they may have excluded these groups.
People tend to be receptive to the technical solution	An organizational development expert who uses an Anti-racism/anti-oppression framework describes the vendor-type relationship expectation that organizations sometimes start the consultation process with. They expect the consultant to work within their specified change parameters and according to their transactional expectations.
Solution can often be implemented quickly, sometimes by edict	A few organizations have training and consultation for their leadership teams and board members. Intervention stops there for a couple of them. The others have plans for the leadership team to use those skills to lead efforts to address race at work amongst staff.
Produces short-term gains for communities, but leaves the existing structure in place	Participant 12 describes how they wrote long policy memos for the people and issues they advocated for. They would make compelling arguments that resulted in changes; however, they spoke for people with lived experiences of hunger and poverty.

Table 4: Transformational Change Transformation in Anti-hunger work

Solves an adaptive problem	A few organizations report that their hiring practices are racially inequitable. Several are reviewing their current practices. One found that withholding salary details made their recruiting process inequitable for people with lived experience of poverty. They also found that language requirements, when unnecessary, benefitted some groups racialized as non-white but restricted others.
Problem is easy to deny (under the surface)	Participant 11's organization transformed its leadership and board to represent better the racial demographic of people with lived experiences of hunger and poverty. They uncovered anti-blackness under the surface of their diversity issue when white and non-black people of color started to question and challenge Black leadership.
Requires change in values, beliefs, roles, relationships, and structure of operations	3 of the 13 organizations are engaged in strategic planning using an anti-racism or race-first equity framework. Their processes require and are led by critically analyzing existing structures, values, and beliefs that govern their organization.
People facing the problem are involved in the work of solving it	One organization recruited a consultant to work with their internal equity team for a year, building their capacity to continue their race-first equity efforts. The consultant helped them create a tool that formalized the consideration of racial impact and racialized power dynamics in their decisions, plans, policies, and programs.
Requires change across organizational boundaries	Several participants either intend to or are already using advocacy to complement their official operations. They hope to move past only providing charity, direct services, and emergency response to target policy changes that can bring about systemic change.
People tend to avoid (or push back on) addressing the adaptive challenge	With an anti-racism/anti-oppression approach to organizational development, the consultant holds a mirror to the organization to help them interrogate their operations and create change specific to their needs. Organizations sometimes push up against that model because they expect the consultant to guide them through pre-determined processes to pre-determined outcomes.

Requires experiments and new discoveries, takes a long time, cannot be implemented by edict	The change process cannot be a fixed procedure. Transformation allows the process to dictate the required change. Also, efforts to address race at work should involve all levels of staff within an organization. Buy-in should come from leadership, staff, and stakeholders.
Shifts cultural values and political will to create racial equity	Participant 12 transformed how they engaged in advocacy to make space for people to advocate for themselves. In one instance, they created a meeting between a federal agency and people affected by their policies. They mediated the discussion, but the participants did most of the talking, interjecting to ensure that participants were not dismissed, interrupted, or spoken over. That shift to first-person testimony was more of an effective tool in legislative advocacy.

As demonstrated, there is a whirlwind of activity and conversation concerning racial equity in the anti-hunger space. There should be careful attention to the impact these efforts have on organizations, individuals working in the space, people and communities they serve, and society at large. Language should specifically name the past and current realities of racial inequity. Efforts should be led and inspired by people with lived experiences of hunger, poverty, and racial oppression. Tools, data, and metrics should hold organizations accountable for creating racially equitable outcomes. Organizations must call out the racialized power dynamics in their operation and commit the human and material resources to rectify them if they hope to get to the root of the racialized power dynamics that perpetuate systemic hunger.

This research has limitations. One of them is a small sample size. 13 participants from 13 unique organizations cannot fully represent the scope of activity in the anti-hunger movement. Additionally, it needs the voices of anti-hunger staff in the southern region of the United States. The participants I connected with have worked in various anti-hunger, civil service, and non-profit organizations. Most have spent over ten years working within the anti-hunger space; a few have over 20 years of experience. They answered questions about their current organization's approaches to addressing race; however, their collective experiences in the movement to end hunger also informed their perspectives. Another restriction was the limited time to complete the work. Racial equity is an extensive topic, and its importance is even greater than that. The five-and-a-half-month period of research could not do this topic justice. However, it will likely trigger individuals and organizations to be very intentional about the ongoing activity to address race in the workplace. This research contributes to the voices demanding that organizations operationalize race equity work in anti-hunger work. More ambitiously, it contributes to resolving the societal debt of racial inequity.

Ultimately, organizational approaches that explicitly center on anti-racism or prioritize advancing society towards racial equity in all aspects, at all levels, with all members, and with the necessary budgets and resources are working towards transformational change. There is no blanket formula for transformational change. It looks different within each organization and is unique to its culture. That is why this report does not offer recommendations or best practices in a prescriptive way. Instead, it adapted a visual from GARE's "Advancing Racial Equity and Transforming Government: A Resource Guide to Put Ideas into Action" to highlight examples of transactional and transformational change within anti-hunger organizations.

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Appendix

Appendix 1 - Racial and Gender Identities of Participants

Racial and ethnic identities are reported as described by participants.

Multi-racial identities include:

- Multi-racial Latina with mixed African and European ancestry
- Multi-racial Afro-indigenous
- Multi-racial African-American and Pacific Islander

Multi-ethnic identities include:

- White presenting Latina

Racial Identity	Woman	Man	Transgender	Non-binary
Asian				
Black or African-American	5	1		
White or Caucasian	3	1		
Latina, Latino, or LatinX				
Native American or Indigenous				
Pacific Islander				
Multi-ethnic or Multi-racial	3			

Appendix 2 – Virtual Survey Questions

- Contact information: Full name, Email address, Phone number
- Personal information: Racial identity
- Work information: Position, title, Organization name, Length of employment
- How would you describe the framework your organization uses to address race? (Select all that apply)
 - o Diversity, Equity, and Inclusion (DEI)
 - o Anti-racism/Anti-oppression
 - o Diversity and Inclusion training
 - o Human resources
 - o Bias training
 - o Write-in response: Other (please specific)
- Does their organization have plans, programs, or policies to address race at work?
 - o Yes
 - What is the name of these efforts? (Please spell out acronyms)
 - Are their specific goals, defined deliverables, and/or a timeline?
 - Do these plans, policies, or programs address race specifically? (As opposed to addressing race amongst other identities like gender, sexuality, age, and ability)
 - Has your organization worked with a third party for training, planning, or consulting purposes specifically concerning race?

- o No
 - Does your organization offer training or informational sessions about race or diversity?
 - Is race addressed in employee onboarding trainings and/or routine Human Resource protocol and communications?
 - o I don't know
 - Does your organization offer training or informational sessions about race, bias, or diversity?
 - Has your organization worked with a third party for training, planning, or consulting purposes concerning race and/or diversity?
 - Is race addressed in employee onboarding training and/or routine Human Resource protocol and communications?
- Matrix questions – Rate your level of agreement with each of the following statements concerning organizational approaches to racial equity. (Strongly disagree to Strongly Agree)
 - o What impact do you think these efforts have on your organization?
 - o What impact do these efforts have on you personally?
- Matrix questions – Rate your level of agreement with each of the following statements.
 - o My colleagues will speak up/ contribute to a conversation about race, even if it makes other white people uncomfortable.
 - o I have witnessed or experienced a white savior complex in food advocacy work.
 - o I have noticed a shift within my organization to prioritize race, diversity, and equity.
- Optional free response – What would you like to know or what would you like to share about your experience in advocacy work or anti-hunger work?
- Would you like to participate in an interview to share more of your experience and insight on the topics of race, racial equity, and anti-racism in the anti-hunger movement? This interview will inform a qualitative analysis of approaches to racial equity in the anti-hunger movement. Any identifiable information regarding the interviewees and the organizations they work for will be kept confidential.
 - o Yes
 - o No

Appendix 3 - Semi-structured Responsive Interview Guide

- Do you consent to having the audio of this interview recorded for data analysis purposes?
- I'd like to start off with your introduction. Please tell me your name, and anything else that you feel identifies you. That could be your racial identity, gender pronouns, geographic location, etc.
- What is your organization's focus? I.e. what does your organization do?
- How long have you worked with this organization?
- What is the purpose of your role in the organization?
- What led you to working with this organization specifically?
- Who does your organization interact with and/or serve?
 - o Would you say that your orgs demographic makeup is representative of the people you serve?
- Is the scope of work local, state, regional, or national?
- How would you describe the framework your organization uses to address race?
- Does their organization have specific plans, programs, or policies to address race at work?
 - o What's is the name of these efforts?
 - o Are there specific goals with defined deliverables and a timeline?
 - o Do these plans, policies, or programs address race specifically? As opposed to addressing race amongst other identities like gender, sexuality, age, and ability
- Does your organization offer training or informational sessions about race, bias, or diversity?
 - o Are these regularly scheduled or one-time training sessions?
 - o Do they outline a specific language around how to talk about race?
 - o Do they use a systems approach, or are they addressing interpersonal dynamics?
 - Is there either emphasis or education about institutional and/or systemic racism?
 - What about racialized power dynamics like white supremacy?

- Has your organization worked with a third party for training, planning, or consulting purposes specifically concerning race?
 - What was the consulting for specifically; racial equity, general organizational development, or both?
 - Is this ongoing consultation or consulting for a set amount of time?
 - Who did the consultant interact with? Leaders, all staff, all together, or in separate groups?
 - Was there an end product or deliverable resulting from the consultation?
 - How visible was the consultation process?
- Is race addressed in employee onboarding trainings and/or routine Human Resource protocol and communications?
- How have or haven't these efforts had a positive impact on you personally, on the organization as a whole, and on the individuals in the organization?
- With the current efforts, do you see a chance for transformational change?
- Have you noticed a shift within my organization to prioritize topics of race equity or diversity, equity, and inclusion?
 - What do you think prompted this shift?
 - How did you notice this shift? Communications or a statement, trainings, etc.
 - What is your perception of this shift?
 - What's at stake if your organization doesn't prioritize topics of race, racial equity, and inclusion?
 - Within internal organizational structure and within the communities your organization serve?
- Will your colleagues speak up when (explicit or implicit) issues concerning race show up at work?
 - Who do you notice as most visible and vocal with discussion concerning race show up at work?
- Have you witnessed or experienced paternalism in food advocacy work?
 - How does it affect the work?
 - How does it feel to show up as a [self-identifies racial identity] person doing this work?
- How do you experience conversations about race in the workplace?